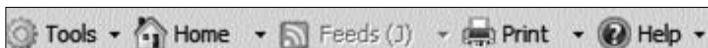


3.1 Internet Explorer

Microsoft has bundled every new release of Internet Explorer (IE) with Windows. The most important aspect of IE is that since it has a market share of approximately 75 per cent, all Web pages are designed to work with it. Apart from that, since IE is bundled with the OS, there is no need to use an alternative browser.

IE 7 has gone through a complete redesign and now supports the opening of multiple pages in one window—also called tabs. Apart from that, the update plugs many security issues with IE 6 and earlier versions. The new design also incorporates an anti-phishing filter and better security settings.



The default icons on the Command Bar

The new design needs some getting used to initially but once you get used to it, you will find it to be more intuitive than IE6. To customise it, right-click anywhere on the toolbar. You can now choose to remove the Menu bar, Links or the Status Bar. You can also reduce the size of the icons by un-checking Use Large Icons. The Customize Command Bar option on this menu allows you to customise the icons visible to the right of the Toolbar.

Just above the Command Bar, you have the search box from where you can search your queries. To access this box quickly, use [Ctrl] + [E]. By default, this box uses Windows Live as its search engine. You can, however, change that to any other search engine—Google, for example. Here's how:

1. Click the arrow on the magnifying glass icon next to the Search Box.
2. Now, click Find More Providers...
3. In the page that opens up, click on the search engine you would like to use and select Install on the next screen.

If you want to use this search engine by default every time you run a search then click the arrow on the magnifying glass again and select Change Search Defaults. Highlight your search engine and select Set Default. You can also remove the other providers if you don't plan on using them in the future.